

Mughal Administration

1. In the Mughal administration 'Muhtasib' was –

- (a) Military Officer
- (b) Head of Foreign Affairs
- (c) An Officer-in-Charge of public morals
- (d) Officer of Correspondence Department

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Muhtasib, the censor of public morals acted as police cum Judge in the observance of the law by the Muslims.

2. In medieval India, why was the mansabdari system introduced?

- (a) For revenue collection
- (b) Facilitating recruitment to the army
- (c) To establish religious harmony
- (d) Ensuring clean administration
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

Akbar introduced a well-organised system in the military and civil service of the empire which came to be known as Mansabdari system. The main intention to introduce Mansabdari was to provide a clean and better administration.

3. 'Madad-i-Mash' indicates in Mughal administration –

- (a) Toll Tax
- (b) Revenue freeland granted to learned person
- (c) Pension provided to military officials
- (d) Cultivation Tax

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

Sometimes, the Mughal administration issued grants as a Madad-i-Mash to pious or otherwise worthy recipients as charity. The spirit of composite culture and harmony was expressed in revenue-free grants (Madad-i-Mash), which the nobles extended to the support of saints, maintenance of religious institutions, religious places and upkeep of Mashaikhs, etc.

4. The meaning of word Bantai during Medieval period was?

- (a) Religious Tax
- (b) System of calculating revenue
- (c) Wealth tax
- (d) Property tax

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The meaning of word 'Bantai' during the medieval period was a system of calculating revenue in which real produce was distributed between state and peasants. Sher Shah Suri opted 3 systems for calculating revenue :

Nasq/Muktai/Kankut

Nakadi or Jabti

Galla Bakshi or Bantai

Bantai was of 3 types (i) Khet Bantai (ii) Lank Bantai (iii) Raasi Bantai.

Music and Paintings of Mughal Period

1. Who did illustrate "Dastan-e-Amir Hamza"?

- (a) Abdus Samad
- (b) Mansur
- (c) Mir Sayyid Ali
- (d) Abul Hasan

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a & c)

Most of the Mughals were renowned as great patrons of arts. The first endeavor was to complete the pictures of the earliest Mughal illustrated manuscript, the Dastan-e-Amir Hamza began in the period of Humayun. It took 15 years to finish under the supervision of Mir Sayyid Ali and then Abdus Samad more than 50 artists completed it.

2. Mughal painting reached its zenith under –

- (a) Jahangir
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Shah Jahan
- (d) Akbar
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Jahangir had an artistic inclination. During his reign, Mughal painting developed further as Jahangir was fascinated with art, science and architecture from a young age. He showed a leaning towards painting and had an atelier of his own. His interest in portraiture led to much development in this art form. The art of Mughal painting reached great heights during Jahangir's reign. His interest in painting also served his scientific interest in nature. Painter Ustad Mansur became one of the best artists to document the animals and plants which Jahangir either encountered on his military expeditions or received as donations. Jahangir maintained a huge aviary and kept a record of every specimen and organized experiments. He patronized the European and Persian arts.